

EchoSpot

Design Proposal by Watermelon

OUR TEAM & COMBINED STRENGTHS

1

Yiqin Cai (Rach)

Master of Interaction Design

*Front-end & UI lead; team
coordinator*

2

Lingjie Ruan (Jay)

Master of Interaction Design

*Programming (Python) &
collaboration*

3

Xiru Wen (Lily)

Master of Interaction Design

*User research & stakeholder
interviews*

4

Jie Wen (Cho)

Master of Interaction Design

*Interaction design & visual
communication*

5

Chuxin Zhang (Cristina)

Master of Interaction Design

*Research synthesis & audio-visual
prototyping*

Combined strength: five Interaction Design postgraduates spanning front-end development, user research, programming, visual/interaction design and audio-visual prototyping — covering the full arc from research to a working prototype.

Where Music Finds Its People

Domain statement

We are interested in **enhancing the way people discover music and connect with each other**. We explore how people can use what previous listeners leave behind at everyday places and activities to discover new music. This could turn solitary listening into a shared experience through social and contextual computing.

Where listening already happens

● Gym

● Studying

● Commuting

● Live venues

The problem space



No existing layer turns a solo listening moment into a shared discovery point for others in the same place or activity.

From personal to collective

How can a solo listening moment become something the next person can discover?

Where We See an Opportunity

There's no way to upload music to the place you're in, so no one else can find it later.

CONCEPTS STILL IN CONTENTION

1 Sound Trace

Upload a track to this exact spot. Others here later can find and play it.

[\[Linked to: interview / observation ref\]](#)

- tunA (MIT Media Lab): turns solo listening into shared discovery
- Scan of app reviews on algorithm bias

2 Mood Marks

Upload a track + a mood tag. See the mood first, then the song.

[\[Linked to: interview / observation ref\]](#)

- PLOS ONE: shared music taste predicts liking
- Nature: enjoyed music boosts closeness

3 Place Mixtape

One shared playlist per spot, and can be built by everyone who uploads there.

[\[Linked to: interview / observation ref\]](#)

- First Monday (Yik Yak): anonymous location sharing builds local community
- Team discussion

Who It's For & What Already Exists

INTENDED AUDIENCE

- P

Place-based music listeners / explorers
People who want to discover or leave music that matches the mood of a specific place.
- I

Independent musicians
Artists looking for alternative ways to share their music and reach new listeners through places and context.
- M

Music Curators
Enthusiastic listeners who enjoy recommending lesser-known music and connecting songs with places, moods, and experiences.
- L

Local visitors/ travellers
People who want to experience unfamiliar places through music and discover how others perceive the atmosphere of a location.

CRITIQUE OF EXISTING SOLUTIONS

Existing Solution	Gap / Limitation	How Ours Differs
Google Maps	Places are mainly represented through photos, ratings and reviews; there is little connection between a place and music.	Connects music to specific physical locations, allowing people to discover and share songs through places.
Instagram / TikTok	Highly visual and screen-focused, which can distract users from looking at and experiencing the physical environment around them.	Makes location the centre of the sharing experience, with music attached directly to a place.
Spotify	Music discovery is mainly algorithm- and playlist-based, with little connection to the user's current physical location.	Enables place-based, community-driven music discovery, linking songs to specific real-world places.

What We Still Need to Find Out

Research → Requirements → Prototype → Evaluation

1

Sharing Motivation

What makes listeners want to share or discover music?

Semi-structured interviews

[week 5 to 6]

2

Role of Context

Does place or activity make music discovery more meaningful?

Contextual interviews & scenario comparison

[week 5 to 6]

3

Social Experience

What kind of interaction feels useful, safe and low-pressure?

Co-design & storyboard testing

[week 6 to 7]

4

Prototype Direction

Which concept should become our proof of concept?

Low-fi prototyping & user testing

[week 7 to 9]